

Gloster Meteor F.8

The Meteor was the first British jet fighter. Meteor Is first went into action in July 1944, and were used against V-1 flying bombs and in the ground attack role, during the last year of the war. The Meteor F8 entered RAF service in 1950, replacing the earlier F4 in Fighter Command. Royal Australian Air Force Meteor F8s were the only British-built jet fighters to operate during the Korean War and took part in the largest air battle of that conflict, in September 1951.

ENGINE 2 x 3,600lb (1,630kg) thrust Rolls-Royce turbojet

WINGSPAN 37ft 1in (11.3m) **LENGTH** 44ft 5in (13.5m)

TOP SPEED 598mph (962kph) **CREW** 1

ARMAMENT 4 x Hispano 20mm cannon



Grumman F9F-2 Panther

Grumman, traditional suppliers of fighters to the US Navy, made their first jet design in typical sturdy fashion. The first aircraft flew in 1947 and deliveries to squadrons began in 1949. Along with McDonnell Banshees, Panthers were the first US jet aircraft in action in Korea, mainly in the ground attack role.



ENGINE 5,000lb (2,270kg) thrust Pratt and Whitney J42-2 turbojet

WINGSPAN 38ft (11.6m) **LENGTH** 37ft 3in (11.4m)

TOP SPEED 575mph (926kph) **CREW** 1

ARMAMENT 4 x 20mm M3 cannon; 2,000lb (910kg) bombload

Ilyushin Il-28 "Beagle"



One of the first Soviet jet bombers, the Il-28, went into service in 1950. Using the same Rolls-Royce derived engine as the MiG-15, it was unknown in the West for several years, but around 10,000 examples were produced. They equipped all Warsaw Pact light bomber units up until 1970, and included reconnaissance and torpedo-bomber types.

ENGINE 2 x 5,950lb (2,700kg) thrust Klimov VK-1 turbojet

WINGSPAN 70ft 4in (21.5m) **LENGTH** 57ft 10in (17.7m)

TOP SPEED 560mph (900kph) **CREW** 3

ARMAMENT 2 x 23mm cannon in nose; 2 x 23mm cannon in tail turret; 6,500lb (3,000kg) bombload

Lockheed P-80A Shooting Star



The first operational American jet fighter, the P-80 arrived in Europe too late to see action during WWII. Although it was designed around the de Havilland Goblin engine, production models were equipped with an American power unit. By the time of the Korean War (1950), the (redesignated) F-80 was the USAF's front-line fighter.

ENGINE 4,600lb (2,090kg) thrust Allison J33-9 turbojet

WINGSPAN 38ft 11in (11.9m) **LENGTH** 34ft 6in (10.5m)

TOP SPEED 558mph (898kph) **CREW** 1

ARMAMENT 6 x .5in machine guns

McDonnell F2H-2 Banshee

The US Navy ordered its first jet fighter in 1944 from a new firm, McDonnell, as Grumman were too busy building piston-engined planes. This was the FH-1 Phantom, which, when delivered in 1945, was too low-powered to be anything but a trainer. With improved engines the design was developed into the F2H Banshee, deliveries of which began in March 1949, beating the Grumman Panther into service by a few months. They were soon in action in the Korean War, mainly as fighter-bombers.



ENGINE 2 x 3,250lb (1,475kg) thrust Westinghouse turbojet

WINGSPAN 44ft 10in (13.7m) **LENGTH** 40ft 2in (12.2m)

TOP SPEED 532mph (856kph) **CREW** 1

ARMAMENT 4 x 20mm M2 cannon; 3,000lb (1,360kg) bombload

Saab 29 "Tunnan"



Universally known by its Swedish nickname "Tunnan," after its barrel shape, the Saab 29 was the first swept-wing fighter built in Western Europe after WWII. Entering service in 1951, the type only retired in 1976. It set several world speed records during the 1950s, and was the only Swedish aircraft ever to engage in combat. This was during the Congo Crisis of 1961 when five UN J29Bs destroyed the Katangan air force.

ENGINE 5,000lb (2,270kg) thrust Svenska Flygmotor RM2 turbojet

WINGSPAN 36ft 1in (11m) **LENGTH** 33ft 2in (10.1m)

TOP SPEED 659mph (1,060kph) **CREW** 1

ARMAMENT 4 x 20mm Hispano cannon; 2,200lb (990kg) bombload under wings

North American F-86A Sabre

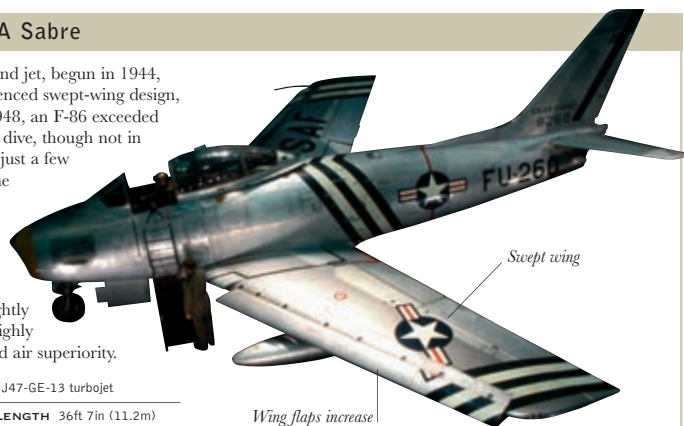
North American Aviation's second jet, begun in 1944, incorporated the German-influenced swept-wing design, to allow for higher speeds. In 1948, an F-86 exceeded the speed of sound in a shallow dive, though not in level flight. In November 1950, just a few months into the Korean War, the USAF was shocked to discover that their jets could not match the Soviet MiG-15 for speed. Sabre squadrons, not yet fully operational, were rushed to Korea. While the Sabre was slightly inferior to the MiG, the more highly skilled US pilots soon established air superiority.

ENGINE 6,000lb (2,725kg) thrust GE J47-GE-13 turbojet

WINGSPAN 37ft 1in (11.3m) **LENGTH** 36ft 7in (11.2m)

TOP SPEED 675mph (1,086kph) **CREW** 1

ARMAMENT 6 x .5in machine guns; 2 x 1,000lb (454kg) bombs



Yakovlev Yak-15

In February 1945, Soviet aircraft designers were instructed to produce jet fighters, but as no Soviet engines were available, they used captured German ones instead. Yakovlev produced this remarkable design by adapting the Yak-3 and replacing its piston engine with a jet one. An all-metal tail wheel was also attached to resist the jet blast.



ENGINE 1,980lb (900kg) thrust RD-10 turbojet

WINGSPAN 30ft 2in (9.2m) **LENGTH** 28ft 6in (8.7m)

TOP SPEED 500mph (805kph) **CREW** 1

ARMAMENT 2 x 23mm cannon above engine